

ADVERTISEMENT

Iowa police officer, license plate reader credited with safe recovery of endangered person

Top Stories: May 14, 2024

By [KCRG Staff](#) and KCCI

Published: May 14, 2024 at 3:40 PM UTC



INDIANOLA, Iowa (KCRG) - The Indianola Police Department is crediting the fast actions of an officer and a newly installed license plate reader camera for recovering a missing and endangered person from Missouri over the weekend.

In a news release, the police department said Officer Drew Stever was on his routine patrol when the LPR camera sent out an alert that the endangered person was in the area.

The officer immediately moved to catch up with the vehicle and initiated a traffic stop at Elk Horn and Highway 65/69, just north of city limits in rural Warren County, Iowa.

The driver of the vehicle was identified as the missing person, who has dementia.

Officer Stever took the person to the police department, where they were able to be safely reunited with family.

[KCCI in Des Moines spoke with Officer Stever](#), who said without the camera, the vehicle would have passed right by him.

The endangered may drove nearly 200 miles undetected, until being pinged by the newly installed camera.

“So I ran the vehicle through my NCIC system and the in-car system and it showed positive that it was a missing person out of Missouri,” Stever said.

The Flock cameras were just installed within the last two weeks to scan license plates and send alerts to officers if a plate matches one on a national criminal database.

“I want to commend Officer Stever for his quick actions,” Police Chief Brian Sher said in the release. “I believe he saved a life today and I know the family is very grateful. I have complete faith and trust in my officers’ ability to think and act quickly and professionally, even when that means leaving city limits or going above and beyond their typical duties because of extenuating circumstances.”

Most Read

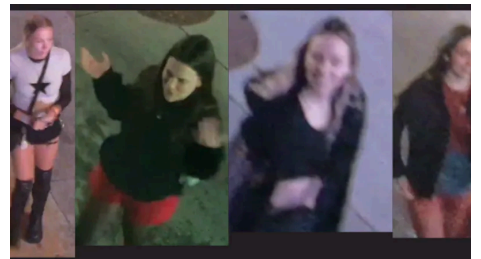
▶ Ped Mall shooting suspect arrested



▶ Driver hits 160 mph attempting to escape troopers on interstate, state patrol says



Iowa City police seek help identifying persons of interest in vandalism investigation



University of Iowa assistant professor charged after allegedly kicking officer



Social media influencer arrested, accused of refusing to pay for almost \$400 of food at restaurant



▶ 'Looking forward to my day in court': Boutique owner arrested 17 times since Jan. 1



Dyersville man suffers life-threatening injuries in tractor crash



Two girls drown in Clarke County creek



Latest News



Gov. Reynolds signs bill expanding charter school funding



First Alert Day on Sunday for strong to severe storms



Two injured following crash at Linn County intersection



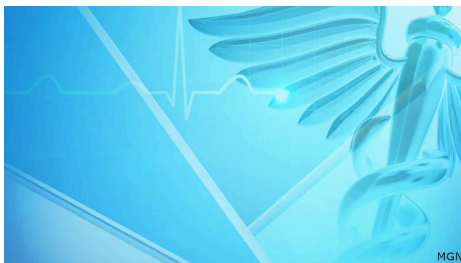
▶ Quad Cities law enforcement officers run torch relay for Special Olympics



Iowa families spending more than during the pandemic in April inflation report



CommonGround previews Iowa's Farm to Fork Road Trip



Man accused of running a fake hospital in Centerville, practicing medicine without a license



Tasty summer bites with The Hotel at Kirkwood Center

[News](#)

[Sports](#)

[YouNews](#)

[KCRG 9.2](#)

[Show You Care](#)

[Athlete Of The](#)

[Week](#)

[TV Listings](#)

[First Alert](#)

[Weather](#)

[Contact Us](#)

[Pinpoint Doppler](#)

[Radar](#)

[Submit a News](#)

[Story](#)

[Cancellations](#)

[Advertise With Us](#)

KCRG

501 2nd Ave SE

Cedar Rapids, IA 52401

(319) 399-5999

[Public Inspection File](#)

[FCC Applications](#)

programming@kcrg.com - (319) 399-5999

[Closed Captioning/Audio Description](#)

[Terms of Service](#)

[Privacy Policy](#)

[EEO Statement](#)

[Advertising](#)

[Digital Marketing](#)

[Boxing](#)

[Cookie Settings](#)

[Click here to learn more about our approach to artificial intelligence.](#)

A Gray Local Media Station © 2002-2026

